

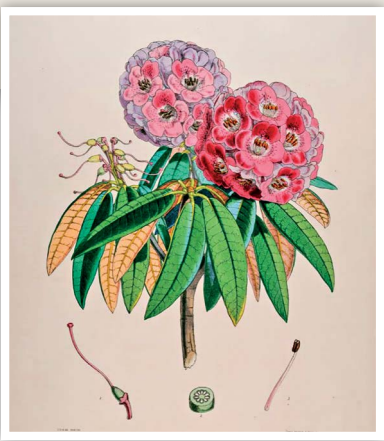
WAYS OF SEEING Visitors at Humayun's Tomb museum; relief fragment of Gandharan art, mid-1st century; ewer made of stonepaste, 10th century

Civiltà ('museum of civilisations' in Italian), Rome. The exhibition has been curated by the Italian archaeologist Laura Giuliano and will be on display for another two months.

Among the many fascinating themes explored here is the preponderance of birds—drawn/ etched kissing or with their necks intertwined. A late 10th- or early 11th-century AD marble panel from the Sorrento Cathedral in Italy shows a pair of ducks drawn this way. An 11th-century water basin from Ghazni, Afghanistan, also shows birds with their necks intertwined, as does a 10th-century bowl from Iran—suggesting that the European artists working with this motif were influenced by Islamic art. There are other themes and motifs that crop up in artefacts collected around the world—like the legend of Layla-Majnun, certain moments from the Buddha's life story, and so on. *Shared Stories* emphasises a pluralistic, multi-modal history of the world, one where notions of cultural 'authenticity' are trumped by the ingenuity of artistic exchange. ■

—Aditya Mani Jha

The exhibition is on till May 30



is generated; why the image becomes integral to this interest in plants; how the name and naming conventions play an important role; and the people making these images. The second gallery examines where these images are being made, how they are being circulated and what their afterlives are. Do not miss the old images of Bengaluru's Lalbagh when here. And to tie it all together, spend a few minutes at MAP's Subhedar Family Sculpture Courtyard. Here, Bhavana Kumar of Kumar La Noce has created a botanical installation with a selection of local plants. ■

—Bindu Gopal Rao

The exhibition is on till Jul. 5

EXHIBITION ▼

Soul of Khotachiwadi

A SHOW AT 47A GALLERY LAYS BARE MUMBAI'S STORIED AND QUAINT NEIGHBOURHOOD

In Mumbai's *gaothans* such as Khotachiwadi, the imprint of the Portuguese and British can still be seen in preserved heritage bungalows and the lifestyles of the residents. That gallery 47A is hosting a show titled *Shadows of Empire* is very meta, housed as it is inside one such 19th-century home in Khotachiwadi. It features shola-pith and indigo collages by Kolkata-based Jit Chowdhury and mixed media images and paintings by Mumbai's Kaushal Parikh.





HISTORY BYTES Jit Chowdhury's 'Shadows of Empire' and Tushar Tanwar's 'Midnight Brew'

Chowdhury's work using material from Bengal's natural mangroves adds layers of meaning to everyday life in the village. 'Map' brings in the decorative Minton tile design, found in old colonial homes; 'Urban Soul 2' seems to portray Willy Black, guitarist of Girgaon and resident of Khotachiwadi, and many others allow the 'walas' of the neighbourhood a space. Blueprint-like creations by Chowdhury, like 'Tall Shadows', have architectural overtones and yet convey a touch of melancholy.

The bold colours and strokes of Parikh's acrylics on canvas contrast with Chowdhury's moody blues. His bursting-with-life 'Rock Star' is a hat-tip to Khotachiwadi's most famous resident—designer James Ferreira. Parikh also has a series of pen-and-ink sketches on day-to-day moments in the wadi. But perhaps it's his photographs that allow the viewer to understand just how fragile Khotachiwadi's existence has been, , with bungalows disappearing and ugly modernity encroaching from all sides. His diptych 'A Place in the World' truly shows us Khotachiwadi's place in the world. ■

—Priya Pathiyan

The exhibition is on till Apr. 19